

Diversity statement
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I was in high school when I noticed the underrepresentation of women in STEM. I grew up in India, where I went to a cram school to prepare for competitive engineering exams. In my class of twenty-eight students, only four were women. The underrepresentation of women was evident, yet there were very few resources and support for them. I often wondered why this was the case. Why were fewer women than men in STEM fields? I eventually figured that a reason was the lack of proper representation. I wanted to create an environment where women feel acknowledged and valued, encouraging them to participate in STEM fields.

When I began college at the University of Maryland, I was fascinated by the opportunities and resources provided to students. Several on-campus and national tech organizations introduced me to supportive communities for women in technology. I actively became part of organizations that focused on creating a safe space for underrepresented groups. Through clubs like Women in Cybersecurity, Association of Women in Computing, Girls Who Code, BreakthroughTech, Rewriting the Code, and Computing Catalysts, I met individuals who shared the same goals and values.

I saw how representation influences participation. Through these initiatives, I felt glad seeing people like me. I felt more comfortable sharing my thoughts. I met several women who were at top leadership positions, which is not very common to see in the tech field. I started looking up to them. I also encountered women who voiced their worries about their peers undervaluing and underestimating them. Upon hearing their experiences increased my desire to create a safe environment where everyone feels seen and heard.

I have led several workshops through our Women in Cybersecurity club at Maryland, where I had the opportunity to guide and mentor freshman and sophomore STEM majors. I have also mentored people through CodePath organization, giving them resume reviews, interviewing tips, and important resources to study. I have had amazing reviews from students, many feeling more comfortable and confident about majoring in STEM fields.

At Amazon, I wish to continue to contribute to its culture of diversity by creating and maintaining an environment where everyone feels welcomed regardless of their educational background, professional background, gender, or age. I want to help create teams where different ideas and perspectives are encouraged.